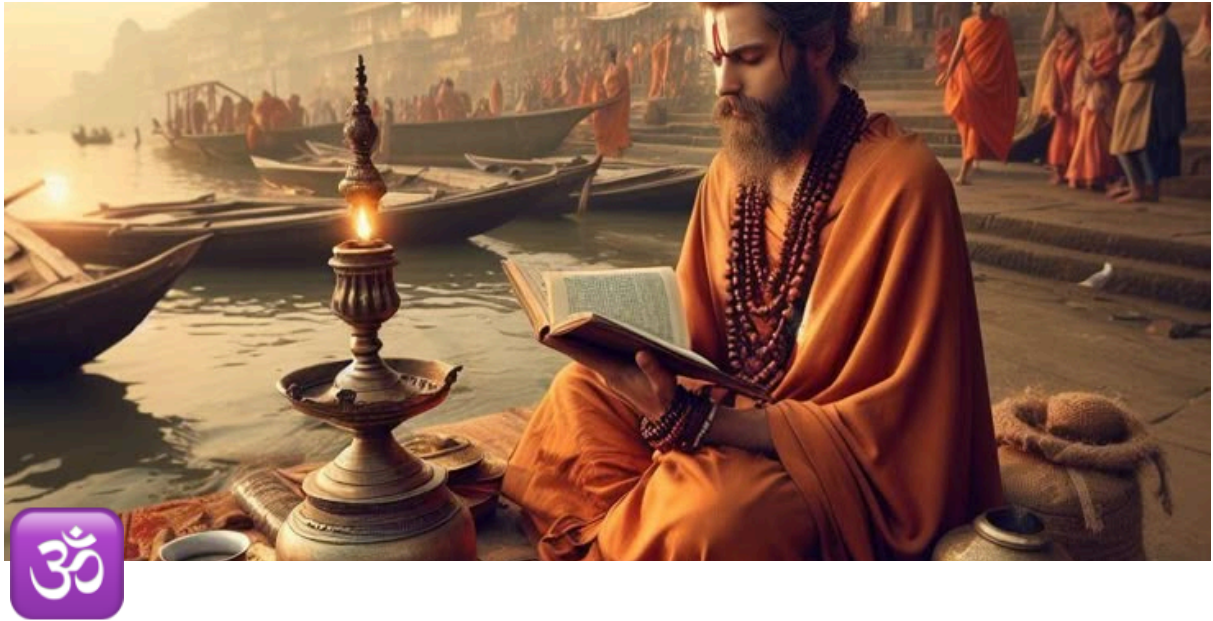




Pantajali's Yoga Sutra

*"yogena chittasya padena vacham
malam sharirasya cha vaidyakena
yo'pakarottamam pravaram muninam
patanjalin pranjaliranato'smi"*

*"Let us bow before the noblest of sages Patanjali,
who gave yoga for serenity and sanctity of mind,
grammar for clarity and purity of speech and medicine for
perfection of health.*

Let us prostrate before sage Patanjali."

**Yoga is based on the Yoga sutras written by the Rishi Patanjali.
Patanjali collected all the knowledge of Yoga in 196 sutras (aphorisms)
divided into 4 chapters.**



The 4 chapters of the Yoga sutra(Pada)

1. **Samadhi Pada:** this first part defines the goal of yoga - samadhi - by describing the essence of yoga. - 51 sutras
2. **Sadhana Pada:** this chapter describes how to reach the goal. The word sadhana means "vehicle" or "quest. That's why this Pada deals with the means to samadhi, the means being practice. - 55 sutras
3. **Vibhuti Pada:** this Pada lists all the powers that a sadhaka (a follower of yoga sadhana) can acquire with practice. Some of these powers are well known to the general public (levitation, insensitivity to heat or cold, etc.). - 56 sutras
4. **Kaivalya Pada:** this last part explains that all the powers acquired through practice are to be used solely for the ultimate goal of liberation - Kaivalya. - 34 sutras

The sutras

There are 196 sutras in the Yoga Sutra. A sutra is an aphorism, stating **the essence of a message**

in as few words as possible. Sutras are therefore very short, with some consisting of just three or four words. Although a sutra is minimalist, sometimes a yogi can

write 4-5
pages to explain the message of a 3-word sutra.

This is the first sutra of the Yoga sutras. I(chapter I).1 (sutra 1) :

1.1 atha yoga anushasanam

"Now yoga will be taught to us, (in the continuity of an uninterrupted transmission.)"

atha : now

yoga :yoga

anu : uninterruptedly

shāsanam : teaching

From this simple sutra, "Now yoga will be taught to us", everyone can have their own interpretation. For example, another interpretation of the sutra might be that "I wasn't there when yoga was created, I'm just following the rules". Indeed, anu can also be translated as "to follow" and shasanam as "rule", and in Indian cosmology Brahma, the creator of the universe, is said to have first uttered the words "Om" and "Atha". This example clearly illustrates the diversity interpretations that can be derived a sutra.

The Samkhya Darshan

Samkhya and yoga are sister schools of thought. It is said that

Samkhya is the theory of Yoga, and Yoga is the practice of Samkhya. They are two Darshans that support each other, like the blind man who can carry the crippled man who can see the obstacles in their way.

Samkhya was founded by Kapil around the 6th century BC , and Yoga was written by Pantanjali in the 3rd century BC.

Samkhya is made up of the words "sama", meaning "complete", and "khyat", meaning "knowledge", and the theory revolves around two fundamental notions.

Purusha and Prakriti.

